

NEWSLETTER

March 2025



Kerala has around 6300 + startups working in various sectors spread across its 14 districts. Our startups work in wide range of sectors including Artificial Intelligence, Hardware, Healthcare, Fin tech, Bio Technology etc.

01

LAUNCH OF KERALA STARTUP MISSION'S HANDBOOK FOR WOMEN STARTUP ENTREPRENEURS

In a significant move towards fostering women entrepreneurship, Hon'ble Chief Minister Shri Pinarayi Vijayan launched the Handbook for Women Startup Entrepreneurs by Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM). This comprehensive guide is designed to empower women in their entrepreneurial journey, offering crucial insights into funding opportunities, and government initiatives tailored to support women-led startups.

The handbook is part of KSUM's broader efforts to build an inclusive and thriving startup ecosystem in Kerala. With the state ranking high in human and gender development indices, there has been a growing focus on increasing women's participation in entrepreneurship. Currently, KSUM supports women entrepreneurs through initiatives like the We Start, We Grow, and We Scale programs, which provide mentorship, market access, and financial assistance at different stages of startup growth



Access it here: <https://startupmission.kerala.gov.in/ecosystem>



02

RELIANCE JIO PRESIDENT MATHEW OOMMEN VISITS KERALA STARTUP MISSION, REINFORCES INVESTMENT COMMITMENT

Mathew Oommen, President of Reliance Industries & Group CEO of Reliance Jio, visited Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) and engaged in discussions with Anoop Ambika, CEO, KSUM, and John Mathai, Former Chief Secretary of Kerala and Corporate Advisor, on fostering innovation, investment opportunities, and startup growth in the state.

He reaffirmed Reliance's commitment to Kerala's startup ecosystem, highlighting the company's ₹21,500+ crore investment in the state and announcing plans to invest an additional ₹5,000-6,000 crore over the next two years.

A key highlight of the visit was an interactive startup pitching session, where emerging startups had the oppor-

tunity to showcase their products, solutions, and market potential, fostering valuable industry connections and opening doors for future partnerships.



03

THE MICROBIOME CONCLAVE AND IDEATHON 2025

Leading scientists, industrialists, entrepreneurs and researchers came together to explore latest advancements in research on microbiome, as the Microbiome Conclave & Ideathon-2025 concluded by serving a platform to explore its applications across sustainability, healthcare and industry.

Hosted by the Centre of Excellence in Microbiome (CoEM) in association with the Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), the event was inaugurated by CoEm Director Dr Sabu Thomas. It was followed by a keynote by Mangalore-based NITTE University Advisor (Research and Patents) Dr Iddya Karunasagar, who is a former officer at Food and Agriculture Organisation.

The event at the KSUM campus in suburban Kalamassery featured experts from diverse backgrounds, fostering collaboration between academia, industry and entrepreneurs, while paving the way for future breakthroughs in microbiome research. Organisers reiterated their commitment to supporting emerging startups and strengthening the microbiome innovation ecosystem in Kerala.

A highlight of the event was the Ideathon, drawing overwhelming response from students, researchers, faculty members and startups – all pitching innovative microbiome-based solutions across five key themes. From over 60 applications, 15 teams were shortlisted to present their ideas before an expert jury. Four exceptional innovations—by MG University Research Scholar S. Gayathri, KUFOS's Preena P.G. of Marine Biosciences, Fathima Faiha N. & team of St. Teresa's College, Ernakulam; and Prof Sinilal B., of Fatima Mata National College, Kollam—were declared winners.

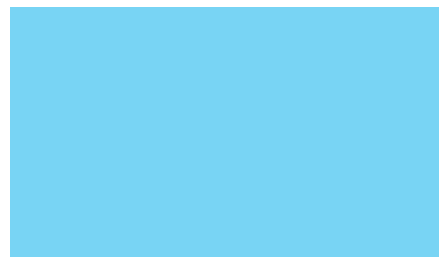
The event also featured a startup expo and exclusive startup presentations, providing emerging entrepreneurs a stage to showcase their innovations in microbiome technology.



04

MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING (MOU) WITH HUB.BRUSSELS

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) has signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with hub.brussels, a regional agency for economic development in Brussels, to accelerate global startup ecosystem development. The MoU was signed in the presence of Her Royal Highness Princess Astrid of Belgium, aiming to accelerate internationalization of startups by providing seamless access to global markets. Hub.brussels will host the 'Startup Infinity Centre' in Brussels, offering free working space, business mentorship, and networking opportunities for selected Kerala-based startups. The partnership will enable bilateral startup delegations, immersion programs, and joint talent, research, and entrepreneurship initiatives.



KSUM STARTUP DELEGATION SHINES AT CONVERGENCE INDIA EXPO 2025

The Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) delegation made a strong impact at the 32nd Convergence India Expo 2025, India's largest technology and infrastructure event, held at Bharat Mandapam, Pragati Maidan, New Delhi.

A 24-startup contingent from Kerala actively participated in the three-day expo (March 19-21), engaging in 30+ investor meetings and 100+ business discussions, while showcasing their innovative solutions to industry leaders, investors, and global stakeholders.

A major highlight of the event was Fuselage Innovations, a Kochi-based agri-tech startup, emerging as the winner at the Startup Pitch Hub. This prestigious recognition secures the startup a fully sponsored exhibition space at Expand North Star Dubai in October and GITEX Europe in Berlin in May. Additionally, Fuselage Innovations has qualified for Super Challenge 2025 in Berlin (June) and the Supernova Challenge Pitch in Dubai, unlocking high-impact global opportunities.



06

FOUNDERS MEET : 26TH EDITION

The 26th edition of Founders Meet brought together startup leaders, entrepreneurs, and aspiring founders for discussions and networking at the Amphitheatre, ISC, Kochi, on March 28, 2025.

The event featured an esteemed panel of speakers, including Venu Gopalakrishnan (Founder & CEO, Litmus7), Anoop Ambika (CEO, KSUM), Sujas Ali (Founder, Aabasoft), Vineetha A K (Founder, Bio-Aryavedic Naturals), and Anisha Cherian (Managing Director, Chemmanur Academy & Systems). They shared their entrepreneurial journeys, challenges, and strategies for scaling businesses, offering valuable insights to the attendees.



07

INNOVATION TOUR MARCH

On March 1, 2025, Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) hosted its monthly Innovation Tour at its Kochi and Trivandrum campuses. The event introduced aspiring entrepreneurs to KSUM's support programs, including funding, mentorship, incubation, and skill development workshops.

Participants had the opportunity to network with KSUM representatives, share ideas, and explore the right support for their startups. The tour provided valuable insights and connections to help turn innovative ideas into successful businesses.



08

LAUNCH OF LEAP CENTRE AT ST. BERCHMANS COLLEGE, CHANGANASSERY

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) has further strengthened its commitment to fostering student entrepreneurship with the launch of a new LEAP Co-Working Space at St. Berchmans College, Changanassery, Kottayam. Inaugurated on March 10, 2025, this initiative marks the second LEAP Centre in Kottayam, reinforcing the state's growing innovation ecosystem.

The launch event, held at Cardinal Padiyara Hall, was attended by faculty, students, and key representatives from KSUM. The initiative, designed in collaboration with the college's Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development Centre (IEDC), aims to provide early-stage student entrepreneurs with mentorship, resources, and collaborative opportunities to turn their ideas into viable ventures.

As part of the event, young innovators were honored with the Student Entrepreneur Awards, recognizing their exceptional contributions to the startup ecosystem. The awards celebrate the entrepreneurial spirit among students and highlight KSUM's dedication to nurturing innovation-driven enterprises in academic institutions.



09

FINANCIAL FOUNDATIONS FOR STARTUPS

Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) organized the Financial Foundations for Startups session, on March 28, 2025, at the KSUM Office, Kochi. The session provided startup founders with crucial insights into accounting, taxation, compliance, and financial strategy.

Expert speakers CA Kannan Surendran (CEO, FinLead) and CA Govind Sekhar (Partner, Varma & Varma Chartered Accountants) led engaging discussions on financial planning, valuation, fundraising, and investor readiness. Participants discussed real-world financial challenges and best practices for managing startup finances. The event concluded with a networking session, allowing founders to connect with finance experts and fellow entrepreneurs.





10

MASTERCLASS ON ACCOUNTING & COMPLIANCE

Kerala Startup Mission successfully hosted an exclusive Masterclass on Accounting & Compliance, led by Pugal T, Subject Matter Expert #1 at Tally Solutions Pvt. Ltd., at our Trivandrum and Kochi offices on 05th and 12th March, 2025.

The session provided startups with key financial insights, compliance essentials, and best practices to ensure smooth business operations. Participants gained hands-on knowledge in accounting fundamentals, tax regulations, and financial management strategies crucial for scaling their ventures.



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AUSTRALIA INDIA INSTITUTE DELEGATION VISITS KSUM

Kerala Startup Mission had the privilege of hosting The Hon. Lisa Singh, CEO of Australia India Institute, along with a distinguished delegation. The visit facilitated fruitful discussions on strengthening bilateral startup collaborations, innovation exchange, and unlocking new opportunities between India and Australia.

With a shared vision for fostering entrepreneurship and technological advancements, the discussions focused on potential partnerships, knowledge sharing, and market expansion for startups in both regions. This visit marks an important step towards deepening innovation-driven ties between India and Australia, reinforcing Kerala's position as a dynamic startup hub with a global outlook.



12

INDO-GERMAN CHAMBER OF COMMERCE VISIT

The Indo-German Chamber of Commerce delegation visited Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM), engaging in insightful discussions with Anoop Ambika, CEO, KSUM to explore Kerala's flourishing startup ecosystem and the state's proactive initiatives to attract global investments. The discussions provided a deeper understanding of Kerala's strategic efforts in fostering innovation, entrepreneurship, and international collaborations.

As part of the visit, the delegation also interacted with emerging startup entrepreneurs, gaining valuable insights into their startup journeys, technological advancements, and market potential. This exchange highlighted Kerala's evolving startup landscape and its alignment with Germany's innovation-driven industries.

The visit aimed to strengthen Indo-German ties, identify investment avenues, and foster long-term business collaborations. Dr. Syed Ibrahim, Honorary Consul of the Federal Republic of Germany in Thiruvananthapuram, was also present, further reinforcing the commitment to enhancing bilateral partnerships in business and innovation.



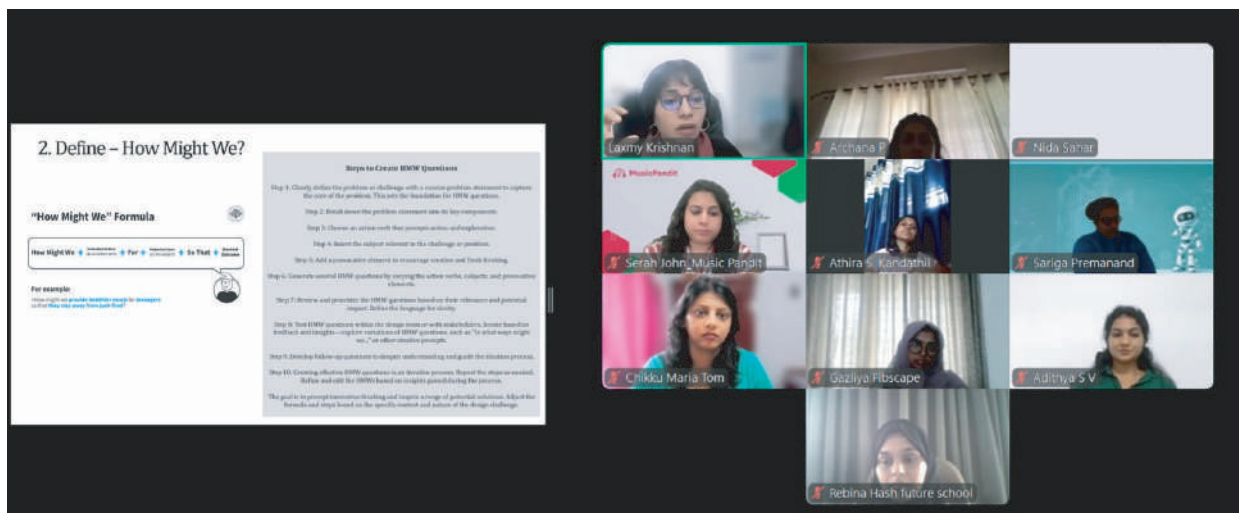
13

WE GROW KICKS OFF WITH AN INSIGHTFUL SESSION ON INNOVATION & STRATEGY

The first session of WE Grow commenced with an engaging and insightful session led by Laxmy M Krishnan, Director & Head of Innovation at Wipro.

The session provided founders and entrepreneurs with key strategies on advanced customer profiling, segmentation, competitor analysis, and the value proposition canvas, offering a structured approach to understanding customers and refining business models. Participants also explored frameworks for mapping problem-solution fit, validating critical challenges, and leveraging feedback loops for continuous improvement.

This marked an impactful start to the WE Grow program, setting the stage for the upcoming knowledge-sharing and mentorship sessions designed to empower women entrepreneurs.



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ORACLE APEX UTSAV 2025 AT KSUM, KOCHI

The Integrated Startup Complex at Kerala Startup Mission hosted Oracle APEX Utsav 2025 on 15 March 2025, bringing together Oracle ACEs, industry leaders, and tech enthusiasts. The event featured insightful keynotes, expert sessions on AI and low-code development, and valuable networking opportunities. The event featured the vibrant tech community in Kochi and highlighted Oracle APEX's role in shaping the future of application development.



15

WEWIN 2025

The WeWin 2025, organized by Headstart Kerala, took place on March 22, 2025, at KSUM Kalamassery, empowering women entrepreneurs through expert-led sessions. The event featured a Master Class on Resilience in Entrepreneurship by Vinitha Joseph and a Finance for Women Entrepreneurs session by Nisary Mahesh, followed by a FireSide Chat on Scaling with Speed.

A pitching and mentoring track was held exclusively for registered women entrepreneurs, providing personalized guidance. The event concluded with a networking session, fostering collaboration and growth, making WeWin a valuable platform for aspiring and established women entrepreneurs.



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EMPOWERING FOUNDERS: A DEEP DIVE INTO FUNDING & GTM STRATEGIES

The Decoding Funding & GTM Roadmap for Early-Stage Founders session was a power-packed learning experience, equipping entrepreneurs with practical strategies to navigate fundraising, market entry, and scaling challenges.

Led by industry experts Pushkar Singh (Founder, Tremis Capital) and Sandeep Balaji (Founder, IncrementumX), the session provided actionable insights into investor expectations, funding strategies, and growth frameworks tailored for early-stage startups.

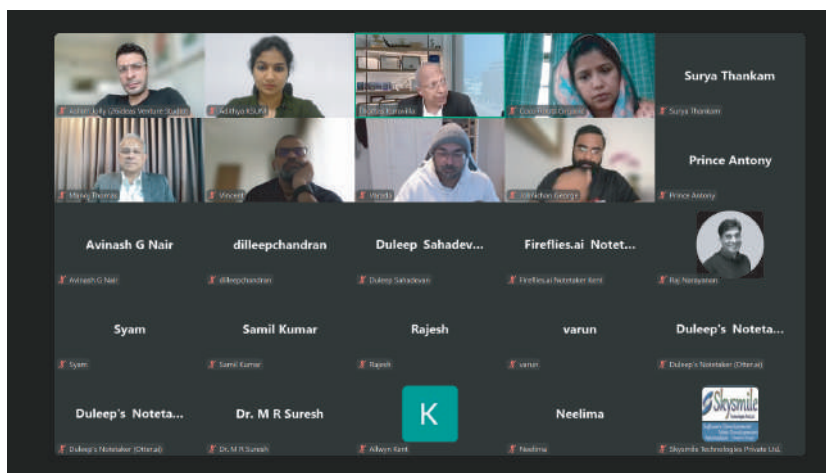


Hosted at KSUM Meetup Cafe, Trivandrum, this 7-hour intensive session offered founders real-world case studies, hands-on guidance, and networking opportunities, ensuring they left with tangible takeaways to accelerate their startup journey.



17

MENTOR LAUNCHPAD MARCH EDITION



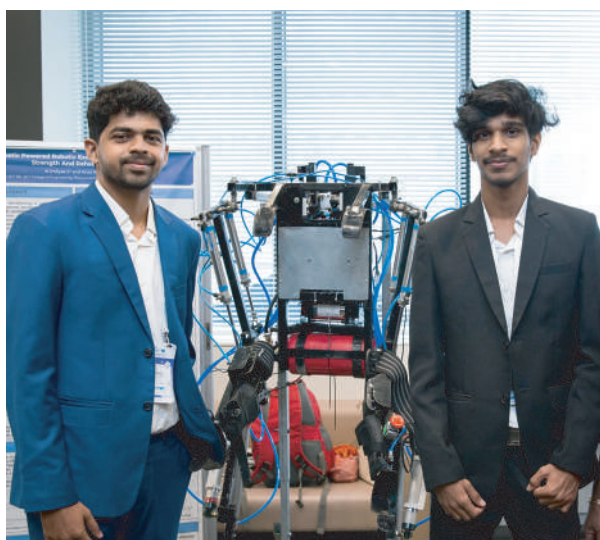
Kerala Startup Mission (KSUM) hosted the second session of Mentor Orientation Session on March 27, 2025, introducing newly onboarded mentors to Kerala's startup ecosystem. Speakers included Thomas Kuruwila (Arthur D. Little Middle East & India), Surya Thankam S (KSUM), and Dr. Shalima (Cocoroots Organic). The session covered KSUM's mentorship framework, startup success stories, and interactive discussions, equipping mentors to support and guide startups effectively.

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IEDC PROJECT OF THE MONTH

ECONOMIC INNOVATIONS: TRANSFORMING REHABILITATION AND RUBBER-TAPPING THROUGH CUTTING-EDGE TECHNOLOGY

Exobonic Innovations Pvt. Ltd., a pioneering startup incubated at Maker Village, Kerala Start-up Mission (KSUM), Kochi, is making significant strides in both robotic rehabilitation and agri-tech automation. Under the leadership of CEO AI Imtias S and CTO Arun A, the company is dedicated to developing cost-effective, accessible, and scalable solutions to address real-world challenges. Both founders are actively involved in the Innovation and Entrepreneurship Development Centre (IEDC) at SCT College of Engineering, Pappanamcode, Trivandrum, where their entrepreneurial journey took shape.



One of Exobonic Innovations' flagship projects focuses on robotic rehabilitation for individuals with locomotor disabilities. Inspired by a deeply personal mission—stemming from the CEO's father's medical condition—the team has designed a pneumatic-based robotic rehabilitation device. This advanced system enables customizable gait pattern rehabilitation and physiotherapy, helping individuals regain mobility safely and effectively.

The company's innovative approach has garnered international recognition, including:

- Top 10 placement in Asia at the IEEE-R10 Robotic Competition and Conference in Japan
- Recognition from IHNA Health Institute, Australia
- State-level winner of YIP 5.0 conducted by K-DISC

By leveraging partnerships with government medical institutions and research organizations, Exobonic Innovations continues to refine its technology. The device has demonstrated promising results in reestablishing neural pathways, offering new hope for individuals with spinal cord injuries, stroke-related impairments, and accident-related disabilities.

In addition to healthcare innovations, Exobonic Innovations is addressing skilled labor shortages in the rubber industry with its semi-automated and fully autonomous rubber-tapping machine.

This solution is designed to:

- Simplify latex extraction, enabling even non-skilled workers to tap rubber trees efficiently Enhance productivity with a fully autonomous system that taps trees and manages the collection process
- Support both large-scale plantations and small growers, incorporating feedback from plantation owners in Kottayam and across Kerala

By integrating cutting-edge automation technology, the company aims to improve efficiency and sustainability in rubber farming, making it more accessible and profitable for farmers.

With a strong foundation in deep-tech R&D, Exobonic Innovations remains committed to developing transformative solutions that bridge technology with real-world applications. Backed by KSUM's Maker Village and key industry stakeholders, the company continues to expand its impact—driving progress in both healthcare and agriculture.

To learn more about Exobonic Innovations and their pioneering projects, visit <https://www.exobonic.com>

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RINK CORNER

IIT PALAKKAD'S CIF & CMFF FACILITIES OPEN DOORS FOR KSUM UID STARTUPS

In a significant boost to Kerala's deep-tech and hardware startup ecosystem, IIT Palakkad's Central Instrumentation Facility (CIF) and Central Micro-Nano Fabrication Facility (CMFF) have introduced exclusive rate slabs for startups under Kerala Startup Mission's (KSUM) UID program. This initiative aims to democratize access to high-end research and development (R&D) infrastructure, enabling startups to leverage cutting-edge scientific equipment at more affordable costs.

Startups focusing on nanotechnology, semiconductor research, material sciences, biotechnology, and advanced electronics often face challenges in accessing state-of-the-art fabrication and testing facilities due to high costs. With this initiative, KSUM UID startups can now utilize world-class equipment at IIT Palakkad, allowing them to accelerate prototyping, enhance product development, and strengthen their innovation capabilities.



EXCLUSIVE RATE SLAB FOR KSUM UID STARTUPS AT IIT PALAKKAD

EXPLORE THE SPECIAL RATES AT THE CENTRAL INSTRUMENTATION FACILITY (CIF) & CENTRAL MICRO-NANO FABRICATION FACILITY (CMFF) AT IIT PALAKKAD

Get Affordable access to advanced equipment & technologies!

LEARN MORE:
instruments.startupmission.in

Beyond IIT Palakkad, KSUM is actively working to connect startups with scientific instrumentation facilities across Kerala. Entrepreneurs looking for high-end equipment, testing labs, and R&D infrastructure can explore available resources through the Instrumentation Data Portal at <https://instruments.startupmission.in>.

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GOVERNMENT AS A MARKETPLACE



FEBRUARY- MARCH

Technical Committee Evaluation

The Startup Procurement Technical Committee conducted four meetings between October and January to evaluate the following projects

SI No	Name of the Department	Requirement	Startup	Amount Approved (in Lakhs)
01	Kerala State Road Transport Corporation	Digital Inventory Management System	Einblick Consultants	24.5
02	Irrigation Design & Research Board (IDRB)	Development of a Centralized Web Portal for a Flood Forecasting System in Pamba Basin – Phase I	Magno Innovation Lab	7.1
03	Directorate of Kerala State Lotteries	Development of a New Website for the State Lotteries Department	SRV IT Hub	2.8
04	Kerala State Council for Science, Technology & Environment	Media Consultant for KSCSTE and it's R&D Centers	Bridging Dots Media Solutions Private Limited	2.88
05	Ramamangalam Grama Panchayat	Bailing Machine	Floret Technologies	6
06	Social Audit Society Kerala	Development of Web & Mobile App for Social Audit Survey	Ipromise Solutions	2.95
07	Ernakulam Regional Co-operative Milk Producer's Union Ltd (ERCMPU)	Purchase of Aerolyz Air Sterilizers	Panlys Nanotech India Pvt Ltd	35.1
08	Center for Science in Society	Supply of equipment and consumables for the Creative Corner Project	Suee Store LLP	298.71

09	Kerala Toddy Industries Development Board	Development of a New Website	COLLABORATIVE LEARNING LABS Private Limited	1.4
10	Chief Electoral Office	Voters Participation Campaign	Bridging Dots Media Solutions Private Limited	12.72
11	Kerala State Road Transport Corporation	Online Booking System for KSRTC Budget Tourism Project	Bayesian Ways	a transaction charge of 0.99% per ticket per passenger.
12	Nochad Grama Panchayat	Procurement of Menstrual Cups	Acolyte Healthcare LLP	2.26
13	Chief Conservator of Forests (IT)	Maintenance & Management of IT Systems for Kerala Forest Department	Leopard Tech Labs	24
14	KINFRA	Development of Website for KINFRA International Exhibition cum Convention Centre	Bz Analytics	1.35
15	Kerala State Industries Development Corporation	Track Expressions of Interest (EOI) System(Web & Mobile App) & MOU - Management System (Web Module)	Mojgenie Private Limited	5.05
16	Suchitwa Mission	Swachhata Green Leaf Rating and Gap Assessment Portal	SRV IT Hub	5.05
17	Directorate of Kerala State Lotteries	Development of Prize Machine Prototype	BMS Cloud Campus LLP	5.9
18	Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau	Upgradation of Website	Divegrid Private Limited	1.9
19	Directorate of Insurance Medical Services	Medical Reimbursement Claim Management System(MRCMS)	Turqosoft	8.96
20	Kerala State Institute of Design	Development of Website and Student Management System	Arvension Technologies LLP	12
21	Kurukkanmoola CHC	Procurement of Menstrual Cups	Femisafe India	1.26
22	Perambra CHC	Procurement of Menstrual Cups	Femisafe India	1.89
23	Pudussery Grama Panchayat	AMC Renewal of LPG Crematorium	Techno Rigs Enterprises	4.18
24	AMRUT Mission	Enhancements to the Project Management System	Travansoft	4.55
25	Kerala State Electricity Board	Web Application Software for KSEBL Power System Engineering Wing	SRV IT Hub	16
26	Kerala Startup Mission	Procurement of Furniture	Carbon and Whale Sustainable Innovations Pvt Ltd	5.83
27	Kerala State Beverages Corporation	Mobile Application for Kerala State Beverages Corporation	Trois Infotech Pvt Ltd	17.7
28	Kerala State Electricity Board	Designing and developing a Comprehensive Application for Metering, Billing, Collection, and Other Services for LT & HT Consumers of KSEBL	XOCORTX ADVANCED SYSTEMS LLP	

29	CDIT	Setting up of a platform for implementing SMS, WhatsApp and Google RCS	Greenads Global Pvt Ltd	
30	Tourism Department	Keravan App	Kawika	8.5
31	Kerala Development Innovation and Strategic Council	Purchase of IoT Hardware Setup & Integration	Realmeds Technologies	2.36
32	Kerala Development Innovation and Strategic Council	Development of Ai Chatbot for eHealth	Bz Analytics	32.67
33	KIIFB	Development-Deployment-Maintenance of a Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting System for KIIFB	Climate Force Technologies	8.15

To know more: <https://gm.startupmission.in/>

No of EOIs	25
Project Under Evaluation	7
Projects Approved	33
Value of work orders(in Lakhs)	666.32
Active EOIs	2

MENTORSHIP STATS

49	TOTAL ENGAGEMENTS		
33	MENTORS ONBOARDED	27	STARTUPS
41	MENTORS	27	HOURS

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